



RCCG OCEANIA

Spiritual Disciplines

Knowing God and Doing Exploits

At a Glance

BIG IDEA

Two short verses sketch a whole discipleship pathway: keep God's Word continually before you, and let it shape what you do. As you grow in truly knowing God, you are strengthened to stand firm and act boldly. This study traces that simple, repeatable rhythm—Word, obedience, and God-knowledge leading to spiritual strength and impact.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

Joshua 1:8a

Joshua 1:8b

Daniel 11:32a

Daniel 11:32b

Key Takeaways

- God's Word is meant to stay in our mouths and minds, not remain closed or occasional (Joshua 1:8a).
- Meditating "day and night" forms steadiness and direction for daily living (Joshua 1:8b).
- Obedience is the intended outcome of meditation, not mere information (Joshua 1:8b).
- There is a decisive difference between those who merely know about God and those who "know their God" (Daniel 11:32b).
- Knowing God produces strength that expresses itself in action—"be strong, and do exploits" (Daniel 11:32b).

Introduction

Spiritual strength and effective action are not produced by occasional inspiration; they grow out of a steady, repeatable rhythm. Joshua 1:8 presents a Word-centered pattern: keep the Book of the Law close, meditate on it day and night, and observe to do what it says. Daniel 11:32 adds a defining contrast: some are turned aside, but those who know their God are anchored, made strong, and moved to ...

Introduction (cont.)

act. Together these verses map a simple discipleship pathway—Scripture continually present, Scripture deeply pondered, Scripture carefully obeyed, and God personally known—resulting in strength that is expressed through faithful, decisive deeds.

Scripture Reading

- **Joshua 1:8** — A concise pattern for Word-centered living: keep the Book of the Law continually present, meditate on it day and night, and observe to do what is written.
- **Daniel 11:32** — A sharp contrast of responses under pressure, highlighting that those who know their God are strengthened and act decisively.
- **Joshua 1:8a** — The opening clause emphasizes ongoing engagement with the Word—close enough to shape speech and attention.
- **Joshua 1:8b** — The progression is clear: meditate day and night, then observe to do according to all that is written.

Scripture Reading (cont.)

- **Daniel 11:32a** — The first half establishes a contrast, preparing focus on what sustains faithfulness.
- **Daniel 11:32b** — The core statement: those who know their God will be strong and do exploits.

Key Points

1. **Keep the Word Present** — Joshua 1:8 begins with a simple command: the Book of the Law is not to drift to the margins. God's Word is meant to remain close—available, remembered, and ready to guide speech and decisions. Keeping Scripture “present” is more than owning it or hearing it occasionally. The wording points to continual access and continual engagement, so that the Word becomes a steady reference point rather than an ...

Key Points (cont.)

1. **Keep the Word Present (cont.)** — emergency resource. Practically, this means the Word is near enough to shape what is said and what is considered. When Scripture is regularly on the lips and before the mind, it becomes harder to compartmentalize faith away from daily life.
 - Choose a consistent way to keep the Book of the Law in view (readable format, repeated review, or memorized portions).
 - Practice speaking Scripture appropriately in prayer and in personal confession so the Word is “in the mouth,” not only in the mind.
 - Reduce competing noise by setting a protected time where Scripture is the first input of the day or the last reflection at night.
 - Identify one decision area where Scripture must be brought forward intentionally (speech, relationships, integrity).

Scripture: Joshua 1:8a

Key Points (cont.)

2. **Meditate Day and Night** — Joshua 1:8b describes a rhythm: meditate on the Word “day and night.” Meditation here is sustained attention—returning to what God has said until it sinks beneath the surface. This “day and night” pattern forms steadiness. Rather than living by impulse or pressure, the inner life is shaped by repeated contact with God’s Word, so choices begin to align with what is written. Meditation is active: rereading, reflecting, and turning the text over in the heart. It is not emptying the mind, but filling it with Scripture so that understanding deepens and direction becomes clearer.

- Select a short portion of Scripture and revisit it at two points in the day (day and night) for a set period.
- Ask simple questions during meditation: What does this say? What does it require? What must change in me?
- Write a one-sentence summary of what you are meditating on and review it throughout the day.
- When anxiety or distraction rises, return to the same text rather than chasing new material.

Scripture: Joshua 1:8b

Key Points (cont.)

3. **Move from Meditation to Obedience** — Joshua 1:8b ties meditation directly to outcome: “observe to do according to all that is written.” Biblical meditation is not meant to end in insight alone; it aims at careful obedience. “Observe to do” emphasizes attentiveness and follow-through. It is possible to enjoy learning Scripture while avoiding its demands, but Joshua 1:8 refuses to separate engagement from alignment. Obedience is not presented as selective or occasional. The phrase “according to all that is written” calls for a ...

Key Points (cont.)

3. **Move from Meditation to Obedience (cont.)** — posture of submission, where Scripture sets the agenda—even when obedience is costly or inconvenient.
- After each meditation time, identify one concrete act of obedience that the text requires (a change in speech, attitude, or action).
 - Use a simple question to test progress: What am I doing differently because of what I read?
 - Share one obedience step with a trusted believer for encouragement and follow-up.
 - When you notice partial obedience, return to the text and ask where you are resisting “all that is written.”

Scripture: Joshua 1:8b

Key Points (cont.)

4. **Know Your God Personally** — Daniel 11:32b highlights a decisive difference: some may appear religious or informed, yet the ones who endure and act are those who “know their God.” This knowing is not mere information; it is relational and anchoring. To know their God is to be rooted in who God is—trusting His character, yielding to His authority, and staying loyal under pressure. Knowledge about God can remain distant; knowing God reshapes identity, confidence, and allegiance. This verse does not focus on extraordinary personalities but on a defining reality ...

Key Points (cont.)

4. **Know Your God Personally (cont.)** — available to God's people: deep God-knowledge that steadies the heart when circumstances attempt to erode faithfulness.

- During Scripture time, turn what you learn about God into direct prayer (praise, trust, and surrender).
- Name specific aspects of God's character revealed in the text and rely on them when facing pressure.
- Replace vague spirituality with relational clarity by regularly asking: What does this passage show about God Himself?
- Watch for signs of "knowing about God" without relying on Him (fear-driven decisions, compromised loyalty) and return to God in repentance and trust.

Scripture: Daniel 11:32b

Key Points (cont.)

5. **Be Strong and Act** — Daniel 11:32b connects knowing God to visible outcome: those who know their God “shall be strong, and do exploits.” Strength here is not self-produced confidence; it is the steadiness and courage that flows from being anchored in God. “Be strong” implies resilience—remaining faithful rather than collapsing under pressure. Yet the verse also moves outward: “do exploits.” Spiritual strength is purposeful, expressing itself in decisive, God-honoring action. These ...

Key Points (cont.)

5. **Be Strong and Act (cont.)** — exploits are not defined as fame, wealth, or guaranteed outcomes. The emphasis is faithfulness with impact—courageous obedience and meaningful deeds that align with God’s Word and reflect genuine knowledge of God.
- Identify one area where fear or compromise is pressuring you, and choose a specific act of faith-filled obedience.
 - Pray for strength that leads to action, not merely comfort—asking God to make you steady and faithful.
 - Look for a practical “exploit” that matches Scripture-shaped obedience (reconciling, speaking truthfully, serving sacrificially).
 - Measure strength by faithfulness over time: continue doing what is right even when it is unnoticed or difficult.

Scripture: Daniel 11:32b

Group Discussion

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

Observation

- What repeated actions are commanded in Joshua 1:8, and in what sequence do they appear?
- Which specific phrases stand out in Joshua 1:8 regarding the Book of the Law, meditate, and day and night?
- In Daniel 11:32, what contrast is presented between two groups, and what distinguishes them?
- What results are stated for those who know their God in Daniel 11:32b?
- What words in Joshua 1:8b show that Scripture engagement is meant to lead somewhere beyond understanding?

Interpretation

- What might it mean for the Book of the Law to “not depart” in practical, daily terms (Joshua 1:8a)?
- How does meditating day and night differ from occasional reading, and why would that shape stability (Joshua 1:8b)?
- What does “observe to do” imply about the relationship between learning Scripture and living it (Joshua 1:8b)?
- What is the difference between knowing about God and knowing their God, based on Daniel 11:32b?
- How do “be strong” and “do exploits” fit together—what kind of strength is implied by the text (Daniel 11:32b)?

Application

- What is one change that would help keep the Word more present in your week (Joshua 1:8a)?
- What could a realistic day and night meditation rhythm look like for you, and what obstacles must be addressed (Joshua 1:8b)?

Application (cont.)

- Where are you tempted to stop at insight instead of moving to observe to do, and what obedience step is needed (Joshua 1:8b)?
- What pressures or fears most threaten your loyalty, and how would deeper knowledge of God re-center you (Daniel 11:32b)?
- What is one specific “exploit”—a courageous, Scripture-shaped action—you will take in the next steps, trusting God for strength (Daniel 11:32b)?

Prayer Focus

- Lord, keep Your Word continually before me and shape my thoughts and speech by it.
- Teach me to meditate on Scripture day and night until it forms my convictions and desires.
- Give me a willing heart to observe and do all that You command, not stopping at insight alone.
- Help me know You personally, and strengthen me to stand firm and act courageously in obedience.

Next Step

Choose a short passage to meditate on day and night, write one concrete obedience step from it, and follow through while praying to know God more deeply.

Conclusion

Joshua 1:8 and Daniel 11:32 provide a clear pathway for enduring strength and effective action: keep the Book of the Law present, meditate on it day and night, and observe to do what is written. Over time, this Word-centered rhythm deepens into relational reality—people who know their God. From that knowledge flows strength that does not remain private: be strong, and do exploits. The aim is a steady life where Scripture shapes the inner person, obedience becomes the normal response, and knowing God produces faithful, decisive deeds.